

7.4 Value added services

GPRS: This facility is available with all network operators across all geographical circles. Most network operators offer a “Zero Rental Plan”, where you don’t have to pay for any fixed amount but pay as use. General rates are 1 p or 2 p per Kb. If your monthly usage is under 5 MB, which is approximately checking your mail once a day or a quick Google or Wikipedia occasionally stick with it.

There are plans available for higher usage, where on paying a fixed amount such as Rs. 100 or so, you get some data transfer (say 50 MB) over which you will be charged in a fashion similar to the zero rental plan though maybe at a discounted rate. There are also plans available for unlimited usage, they generally cost you around Rs. 500 or up a month depending on your location, network operator and type of plan.

A small tip, most carriers don’t charge any roaming charges on GPRS service, so confirm the same and enjoy email on the move nationwide without paying extra roaming charges.

Others: These include facilities such as voice mail, roaming discounts, caller tunes, cricket updates, astrology update, stock updates, special ringtones and wallpapers, exam result and everything under the sun and beyond. We won’t discourage you from using them, but would such as to present you with the fact that network operators report the highest profit rate from providing you with these value added services. 